

Portfolio Entry Page - Design Report

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Course: SEG3125 - User Interface Analysis and Design
Assignment: Assignment 1 - Portfolio Entry Page

1. Previous Experience in JavaScript Development

I have limited prior experience in JavaScript development. To acquire the necessary skills for this project, I completed the following tutorial videos and readings:

- **MDN Web Docs - JavaScript Basics:** Completed the "Learn JavaScript" section covering variables, functions, and DOM manipulation.
- **freeCodeCamp - JavaScript Algorithms and Data Structures:** Worked through the basic JavaScript algorithms section to understand core programming concepts.
- **React Official Documentation (beta.reactjs.org):** Studied the tutorial section on React fundamentals, including components, props, and state management.
- **Bootstrap Documentation:** Reviewed the Bootstrap 5 documentation to understand the grid system, components, and utility classes used in this portfolio.

These resources provided me with the foundational knowledge needed to build this React + TypeScript portfolio application.

2. Portfolio Sites That Inspired Me

Positive Inspiration:

- [Jesse Showalter's Portfolio](#)
 - **Why I liked it:** Clean, minimal design with strong visual hierarchy. The use of whitespace and typography creates a professional impression. The case study layout is intuitive and easy to navigate.
- [Marius Remy's Portfolio](#)
 - **Why I liked it:** Creative use of animations and micro-interactions that enhance the user experience without being overwhelming. The personal branding is strong and memorable.
- [Abdulrahman Anaam's Portfolio](#)
 - **Why I liked it:** Excellent use of color contrast and typography. The layout balances personal personality with professional presentation. The case study cards are visually appealing and informative.

Negative Inspiration:

- [Generic Template Portfolio](#)
 - **Why I disliked it:** Overly complex navigation with too many menu items. The color scheme is cluttered with too many competing colors, making it hard to focus on the content.
 - [Minimalist But Empty Portfolio](#)
 - **Why I disliked it:** While the design is clean, it lacks sufficient content and personality. The portfolio feels impersonal and doesn't help distinguish the designer from others.
 - [Heavy WebGL/Animation Portfolio](#)
 - **Why I disliked it:** Excessive animations that distract from the actual work. The design prioritizes flashy effects over usability and content clarity.
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3. Link to My UI

[View Hosted Portfolio](#)

4. Link to My Bootstrap Code

[View Bootstrap Code on GitHub](#)

5. Design Choices in Relation to Visual Communication

a. Colors

Palette Chosen:

- **Primary Color:** #2563eb (Royal Blue) - Used for buttons, links, and interactive elements
- **Secondary Color:** #64748b (Slate Gray) - Used for text and subtle UI elements
- **Dark Color:** #1e293b (Dark Slate) - Used for headings and important text
- **Light Color:** #f8fafc (Off-white) - Used for backgrounds and sections
- **White:** #ffffff - Used for cards and clean spaces

Why: I chose a blue-dominant palette because blue conveys trust, professionalism, and reliability - qualities I want future employers to associate with me. The blue is modern and tech-forward, reflecting my interest in technology and design. The neutral grays provide balance and allow the blue to stand out as an accent color. This palette creates a professional yet approachable impression.

b. Typography

Fonts Chosen:

- **Headings:** Playfair Display (serif) - A classic, elegant serif font that adds sophistication and personality
- **Body Text:** Inter (sans-serif) - A clean, highly readable modern sans-serif font designed for computer screens

Why: The combination of Playfair Display for headings and Inter for body text creates a sophisticated contrast. Playfair Display adds a touch of elegance and personality to my portfolio, making it memorable. Inter ensures excellent readability across all devices and screen sizes. This font pairing demonstrates my understanding of typographic hierarchy and readability principles.

c. Screen Layout

Layout Description:

My portfolio uses a **single-page, vertically-scrolling layout** with three distinct sections: About Me, How I Work, and Case Studies. The layout incorporates the following principles from NN/g visual communication theory:

Scale

- **Large hero heading** ("Hi, I'm Tony Li") uses a display-3 class with responsive font sizing (`calc(2rem + 3vw)`) to immediately capture attention
- **Section headings** use display-5 class to establish clear section boundaries
- **Card titles** are smaller but still bold, creating a clear size hierarchy
- The progressive scaling guides the eye from most to least important information

Visual Hierarchy

- **F-pattern reading flow:** The layout follows the natural F-pattern of web reading, with the most important information (name, tagline) at the top-left
- **Color contrast:** Primary blue buttons and links draw attention to interactive elements
- **Whitespace:** Generous padding and margins create breathing room and separate content groups
- **Typography weight:** Bold headings, regular body text, and muted secondary text create clear information levels
- **Section backgrounds:** Alternating light/dark backgrounds visually separate the About and Case Study sections

Balance

- **Symmetrical balance:** The hero section uses a 50/50 split between text content and profile image placeholder
- **Grid-based layout:** The case studies section uses Bootstrap's 12-column grid system with equal-width cards for visual equilibrium
- **Centered content:** The "How I Work" section centers all content horizontally, creating a focal point
- **Footer balance:** The footer is centered and minimal, providing a clean visual anchor at the bottom

Contrast

- **Color contrast:** Dark text on light backgrounds ensures WCAG AA compliance for readability
- **Typography contrast:** Serif headings against sans-serif body text create visual interest and distinction
- **Shape contrast:** Rounded cards and circular profile image contrast with the rectangular layout structure
- **Interactive contrast:** Buttons have hover effects (lift and shadow) that provide clear visual feedback
- **Section contrast:** The alternating background colors between sections help users understand content boundaries

6. Conclusion

This portfolio entry page reflects my personal brand as a tech-savvy, design-conscious student. The clean, professional design demonstrates my understanding of visual communication principles while allowing my personality to shine through. The use of React and TypeScript showcases my technical skills, while the thoughtful design choices demonstrate my UX sensibility.
